USS TEXAS

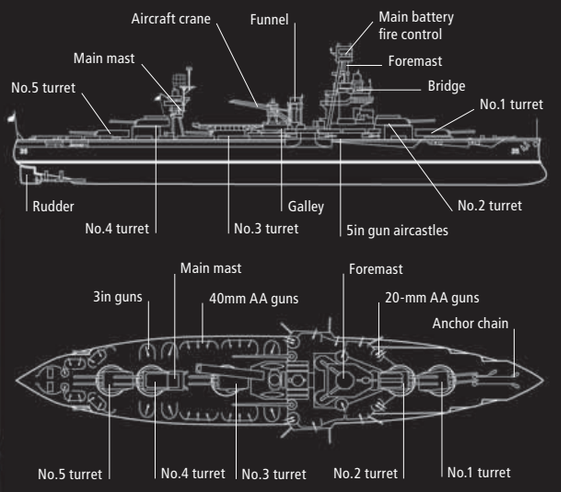
THE NEW YORK-CLASS battleship *Texas*, commissioned in March 1914, was a "super-dreadnought," a product of the naval arms race that preceded World War I. She was especially prominent in World War II in a shore bombardment role, her big guns providing fire support for landings in North Africa, Normandy, Iwo Jima, and Okinawa.

THE USS *Texas* was built at Newport News, Virginia, for a cost of around $6 million. Her main armament of ten 14-in guns made her the most powerful warship in the world in 1914, but in some respects she was behind the times, especially in depending upon coal-fired reciprocating engines instead of oil-fired steam turbines. An extensive modernization in 1927 replaced coal-fired boilers with oil-firing, improved the ship's armor, and upgraded her fire-control systems. Subsequent modifications included the addition of anti-aircraft guns and the installation of radar on board in 1939.

By the outbreak of World War II *Texas* was too slow to hold her own as a warship in battle with more modern capital ships, but her guns still packed a powerful punch and the battleship earned five battle stars during the war. The only combat fatality ever suffered by *Texas* occurred in a duel between the ship and German shore batteries at Cherbourg in June 1944, when a shell struck her armored conning tower. *Texas* was decommissioned in 1946. Now a museum ship at San Jacinto, Texas, she is the last surviving dreadnought-era battleship.



American patriot
The USS *Texas* is adorned with flags for Navy Day in October 1940. During the early part of World War II, before America's entry into the war, *Texas* escorted merchant convoys crossing the Atlantic.



USS Texas
The basis of *Texas*'s influence in both world wars lay with her ten huge 14-in guns, which could fire a 1,500 lb (680 kg) shell a distance of over 13 miles (20 km). The battleship had an active career of over 30 years.

> "SHE WAS A SHIP—THE SMARTEST MAN O' WAR AFLOAT, AND THE BEST. A HARD, TOUGH, SALTY, SHOOTIN' STEAMIN' FOOL. A TROPHY GRABBER, A FIGHTER, AND A HE-MAN BATTLE WAGON."
>
> **LIEUTENANT PAUL SCHUBERT,** CREWMAN ON USS *TEXAS*, 1919–1923



Ship superstructure
On the top of the foremast at the highest point of the ship sits the battery control and the radio and radar antennas. Below this are other areas of the ship that need a high, clear line of sight such as the pilothouse and lookout platforms.







Paravane
Texas carried two torpedo-shaped paravanes which could be towed from the bow to snag the lines of floating naval mines. A sharp blade on the side would cut the mine loose so that it would float to the surface where it could be sunk or destroyed by gunfire.



Ship's bell
A large brass bell, located in the center of the main deck was used to mark the time of day for the crew and regulate the duty watches. The bell is engraved with the name of the battleship.